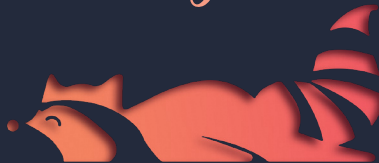




by



The Tired Raccoon



LUMA PROJECT

A Social Platform for Discovering, Learning, and
Playing Board Games

Designed and developed by *The Tired Racoon*
| Langara College | 2025

Cover Design: Nil Yilmaz, Ana Morais
Illustrations: Nil Yilmaz, Ana Morais
Booklet Design: Nil Yilmaz, Ana Morais

CONTRIBUTORS

Zin Min Htun, *Project Manager & Developer*
Oluwademilade Aluko, *Lead Developer*
Ana Paola de Morais, *Lead UX/UI Designer*
Aboubakar Muco, *Developer*
Mekhala Manappatt, *UX/UI Designer*
Sahil Kumar, *UX/UI Designer*
Nil Yilmaz, *UX/UI Designer*

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Zin Min Htun,
Project Manager & Developer

Project Overview

The Problem

The Solution

Key Features

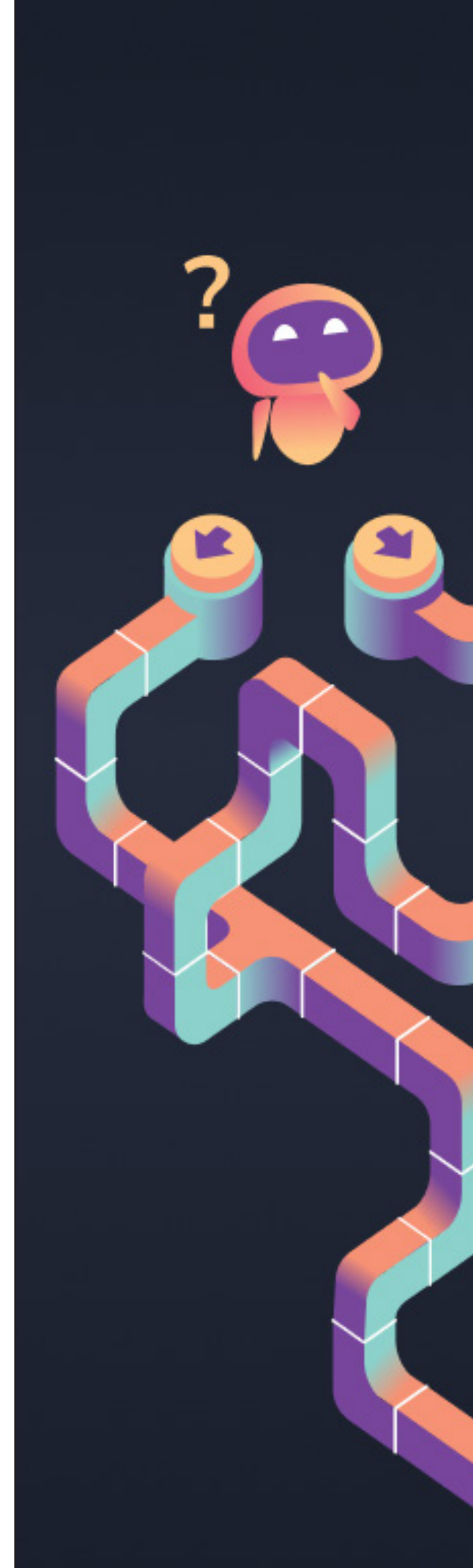
Competitor Analysis

User Research & Data Insights

The Problem

Most people struggle to learn board games and find others to play with. Rulebooks are often confusing or overwhelming, and there's a lack of centralized platforms that both teach and connect board gamers in a meaningful way.

Board games have surged in popularity in recent years, offering rich social experiences, cognitive stimulation, and fun beyond screens. However, a major hurdle for many, especially newcomers, is the complexity of learning game rules and the social barrier of finding people to play with. Traditional rulebooks are often dense, confusing, or poorly designed, leaving players overwhelmed before they even start. Even in social or public gaming spaces, people hesitate to join new games due to fear of not knowing the rules or slowing others down. In parallel, despite a growing interest in local board game cafes and gaming events, there is no streamlined way to discover, join, or create events tailored to individual preferences. Many existing platforms are fragmented: some focus solely on event calendars, others on rules databases or reviews, but none truly guide users from learning to playing in a cohesive, intuitive way. This fragmented landscape creates friction for both casual players and dedicated hobbyists.



The Solution

Luma is a social platform designed to help users learn board games through interactive tutorials and connect with like-minded players by discovering local or online events. No rule book? No problem.

Luma addresses this problem by offering a comprehensive, user-friendly digital platform that simplifies learning and enhances social gameplay. With Luma, users no longer need to fumble through complicated rulebooks or spend hours watching external tutorials. Our interactive, step-by-step tutorials are visually driven and built for engagement, helping users learn by doing. This lowers the barrier to entry for newcomers and builds confidence quickly. In addition to learning, Luma connects players by showcasing local and virtual events they can easily join based on location, game type, or skill level. Personalized recommendations ensure that users discover games and events aligned with their preferences. Whether you're an experienced gamer or someone trying your first card game, Luma makes participation easy, social, and fun. By uniting learning and playing in a single ecosystem, Luma empowers users to grow their board gaming hobby with confidence and community support.



Key Features

Do you want to learn how to play board games?

But unsure where to start?

Can't find people to play with?

Don't know what you might like?



Interactive Tutorials

Learn fast with our beginner friendly interactive tutorials

Discover Board Game Events

Find and host board game events to meet other gamers

Game Discovery & Personalization

Get suggestions based on your level and preferences

Competitor Analysis

Features					
Interactive Tutorials	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Board Game Events	✓	✗	✓	✓	✗
Game Discovery & Personalization	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓

Luma uniquely combines interactive tutorials, board game events, and personalized game discovery in one platform. While competitors like Dized or Meetup offer one of these features none provide all three together in a seamless, user-friendly experience.

Even where tutorials exist (e.g., Dized), we conducted in-depth studies to improve upon them, making Luma’s tutorials more interactive, guided, and integrated with gameplay readiness. Luma fills the experiential and social gaps others miss, making it the most complete solution in the current board gaming ecosystem.

While many apps serve specific niches within the board gaming space, such as BoardGameGeek (database and reviews), Meetup (event discovery), or YouTube (video tutorials), few offer an integrated experience.

Luma’s competitive edge lies in its fusion of intuitive game tutorials and event networking within one seamless platform. Our research shows that users want to learn quickly and play confidently without switching tools or platforms. Luma’s tutorial-first approach fills a gap for experiential learners who benefit from interaction rather than passive reading or watching. In comparison to competitors, Luma not only supports event organizers and game publishers through potential partnerships, but also nurtures player engagement from the very first click.

User Research & Data Insights

Research Summary

Based on survey responses from 41 people, Luma is designed for users aged 20–34 with a mix of gaming experience from complete beginners to regular players.

Most participants:

- Play board games occasionally, usually at home or with friends
- Struggle with long rulebooks, confusing setups, and unclear turn sequences
- Prefer guided explanations over reading manuals

In fact, 19.4% have avoided board games altogether because they found them too complex to learn from a rule book.

What users want:

- Interactive tutorials
- Discover Board Game Events
- Game Discovery & Personalization

Platform preference:

- 93.3% are open to using an app like Luma
- 74.2% prefer using it on desktop

Luma fills a gap for casual gamers who want to enjoy board games without the stress of confusing instructions—and who are also looking for an easy way to connect with other players, join events, and discover new games.

1. Target Users

Age group: Primarily 20–34 years old (80.6%)

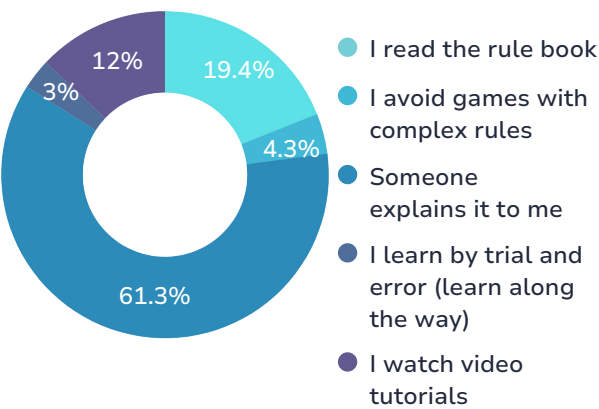
Gaming experience: Mixed — both beginners and experienced players

Where they play:

- Mostly at home or with friends (41.9%)
- Board game cafés (25.8%)
- Online (12.9%)

2. User Behaviors & Pain Points

Learning preferences:



- 61.3% prefer someone explaining the rules
- Only 19.4% read the rulebook
- 4.3% use video tutorials
- 12% have avoided games that look too complicated

Play frequency: Mostly occasionally (71%)

Game types:

- Deck-building/card games (54.8%)
- Party & strategy games (~38%)
- RPGs & beginners (~22%)

Top frustrations:

- 41.9% struggle with turn sequences
- 32.3% hate long/boring rulebooks
- Others: confusing setup, special rules, rule debates

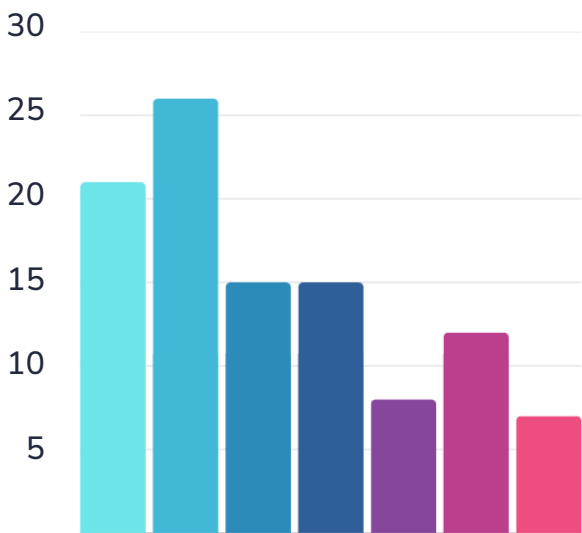
4. Platform Preferences

- Laptop/Desktop is the top choice – 74.2%
- Mobile/tablet is used by a smaller group
- Smart TVs are nearly unused

5. Willingness to Use Luma

- 50% would definitely use such an app
- 43.3% say maybe
- Very few are opposed

3. Top Requested Features



- Step by step game setup
- Visual summaries of rules
- Board game events to meet others
- Interactive turn by turn tutorial
- Personalised difficulty levels for tutorials
- Personalised board game suggestions
- Cheat sheets and beginner friendly strategy suggestions



Nil Yılmaz,
UX/UI Designer

Design and Development Plan

Development Timeline

Design Timeline

Technology Stack

Development Timeline

Planning & Setup (Weeks 1–4)

- System architecture
- Development roadmap
- GitHub repository and collaboration setup

Core Development (Weeks 5–7)

- Database and Firebase configuration
- Initial feature implementation
- Sprint reviews and demos

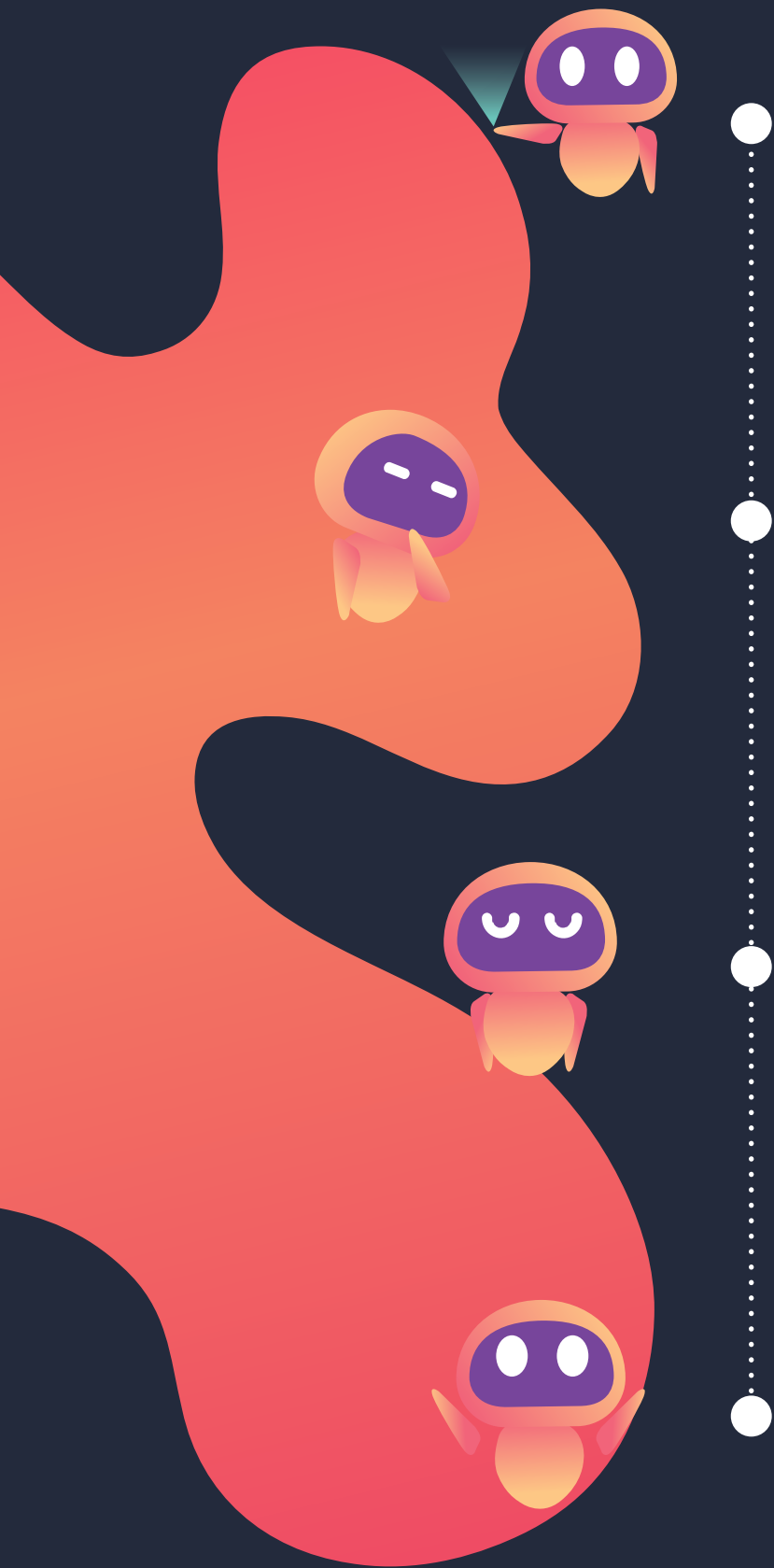
Testing & QA (Weeks 8–11)

- Continuous development
- Bug fixes, feature completion
- Alpha and Beta demos

Finalization & Launch (Weeks 12–13)

- Final QA, bug report, and code freeze
- Dry run and project upload

Design Timeline



Research & Planning (Weeks 1–2)

- Team setup and project idea
- User personas, user flow, and sitemap

UX/UI Design (Weeks 3–7)

- Wireframes and revised UX
- Visual identity: logo and UI kit
- High-fidelity mockups and design refinements

Testing & Iteration (Weeks 8–10)

- User testing and feedback
- Internal QA and issue tracking
- Design–dev collaboration for handoff

Finalization & Delivery (Weeks 11–13)

- Final user acceptance testing (UAT)
- Presentation deck and in-class presentation
- Delivery of final design files

Technology Stack

Luma is built using a carefully selected stack that balances visual quality, performance, and scalability. The chosen tools support both rapid prototyping and production-ready deployment, ensuring a seamless experience for users engaging with board game tutorials and community features.

Design Tools

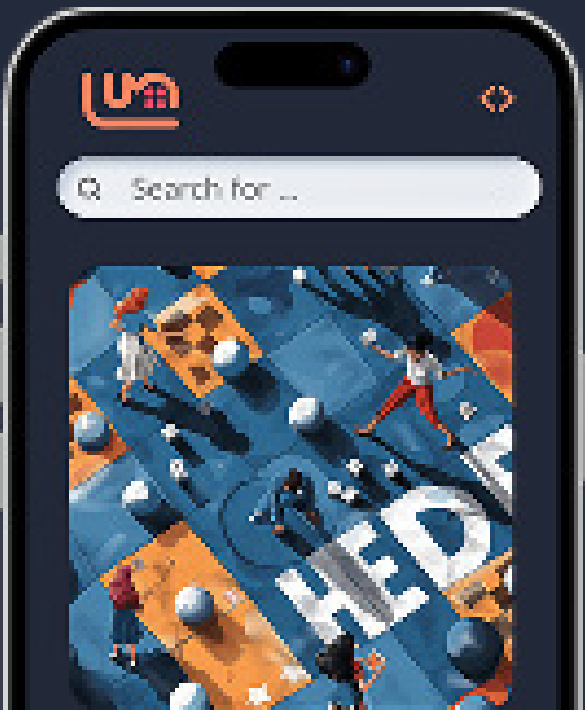
- Figma – Collaborative interface design, prototyping, and handoff.
- Adobe Photoshop – Visual assets, textures, and high-fidelity mockups.
- Adobe Illustrator – Custom icons, branding elements, and vector illustrations.

Front-End Development

- HTML5 – Semantic, accessible structure for web pages and responsive layouts.
- Tailwind CSS – Utility-first framework for consistent, scalable, and modern UI styling.
- JavaScript (Vanilla) – Interactive components and dynamic behavior without relying on heavy frameworks.

Back-End

- Firebase (Google Cloud)
- Authentication – Secure user sign-up, login, and session management.
- Firestore – Real-time database for storing events, user data, and game tutorials.
- Firebase Hosting – Fast and reliable web hosting for Luma’s front-end.





Ana Paola de Moraes,
Lead UX/UI Designer

Design Process

Personas

User Journey & Flow

UI Kit

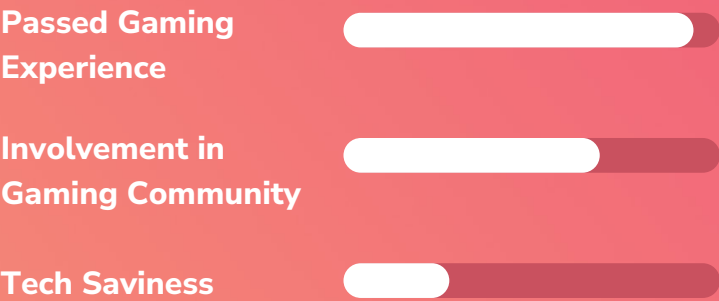
Interactive Prototypes

Wireframes

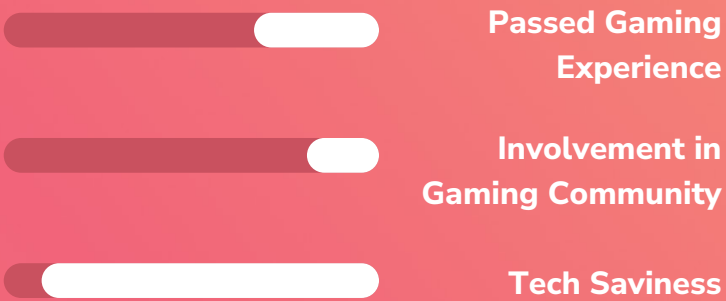
Personas



Valeriya
Photographer



Patel Deep
Developer



About

Valeriya is a passionate board game enthusiast who plays regularly with her local gamer friends. She’s well-versed in a wide range of game genres, from strategy to storytelling games. Although she enjoys gameplay, she often struggles with digital platforms and prefers intuitive interfaces. She prefers getting her information through her community but is open to trying digital tools that feel community-driven and visual.

About

Patel is a curious developer who recently became interested in modern board games. While he’s tech-savvy and used to exploring new apps, he often finds board games overwhelming due to complex rule books and lack of guidance. He usually plays with his partner or solo to explore the mechanics first. Since he doesn’t have a gamer friend group, he’s looking to meet other players and join beginner-friendly events.

Goals & Needs	Frustrations
- Wants to discover and attend real-life game events. - Needs easy-to-access rule references when no one in the group remembers specifics. - Prefers intuitive, visual tutorials over long texts or videos. - Values community engagement and group-based discovery.	- Avoids overly technical apps or complicated interfaces. - Gets annoyed when searching through long rulebooks or poorly organized tutorials.

Frustrations	Goals & Needs
- Intimidated by long rules and complex setup processes. - Doesn’t know where to find people to play with.	- Wants to easily understand how to set up and play a new board game. - Needs beginner-friendly tutorials and suggestions. - Interested in meeting people through events or forums. - Wants to build a personal game library for progress tracking.

User Journey

	Actions	Touchpoints	Pain Points
Discover	Sees an Instagram reel about Luma or a poster at a board game cafe with a QR code. Visits homepage.	Poster, QR code, Instagram ad, homepage	Unsure if this app is for beginners or just hobbyists.
Sign Up	Creates an account, chooses preferred game genres and skill level. Browses tutorial previews.	Signup page, welcome flow, game filter tags	Too much info in early onboarding can feel overwhelming.
Learn	Searches Night Cage, watches visual step-by-step tutorial. Takes an optional quiz. Saves checklist for gameplay.	Search bar, tutorial page, video player, event lists	Doesn't understand a rule, replays a segment too often.
Engage	Register to a local Luma board game night. Gets notification reminder. Attends the event and plays with Luma tutorial.	Event calendar, RSVP confirmation email, push notifications	Worries about slowing others down, especially if they've played before.
Connect	Follows people she met, joins forum thread. Posts her first tip blog and gets feedback.	Blog section, profile system, comment section	Feels shy about writing posts at first.
Reflect	Rates the event, submits feedback on tutorial clarity. Shares Luma with a friend.	Feedback form, referral invite, blog repost	Doesn't know if her feedback really makes a difference.

UI Kit

H1 Title Lorem

H2 Title Lorem Ipsum

Tag Title Lorem Ipsum

Inactive card title

Active card title

Paragraph Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Aliquam nisi ligula, porta at porta viverra, ultricies...



Kevin McMillan

Jazz lover, board game guru, and CSS wizard. Kevin hosts laid-back game nights with brainy vibes and witty...

 35 users subscribed

Subscribe

01:00 AM

Selector Showdown

 by Kevin McMillan

 Langara College B Building

 22/35 Ana Paola, Mekhala, Sahil and 19 others



The Night Cage



Trapped in the darkness, reveal paths, escape together...

Tutorial

Button-MD

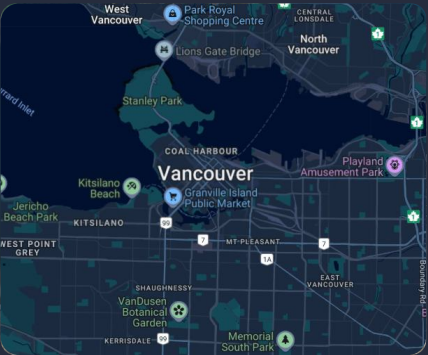
Button-MD

Button-MD

Vancouver

Discover the hottest events in Vancouver, and get notified of new events before they sell out.

Subscribe



ArcaneAdventurer

I'm a little nervous about the horror elements, but I'm also super excited! This should be an unforgettable experience.



Settings

Customize your account settings, notifications, and security.

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75%

50%

60%

Interactive Prototype

Wireframes



No rulebook?
No problem.

Scan the QR code
and start learning
with Luma!





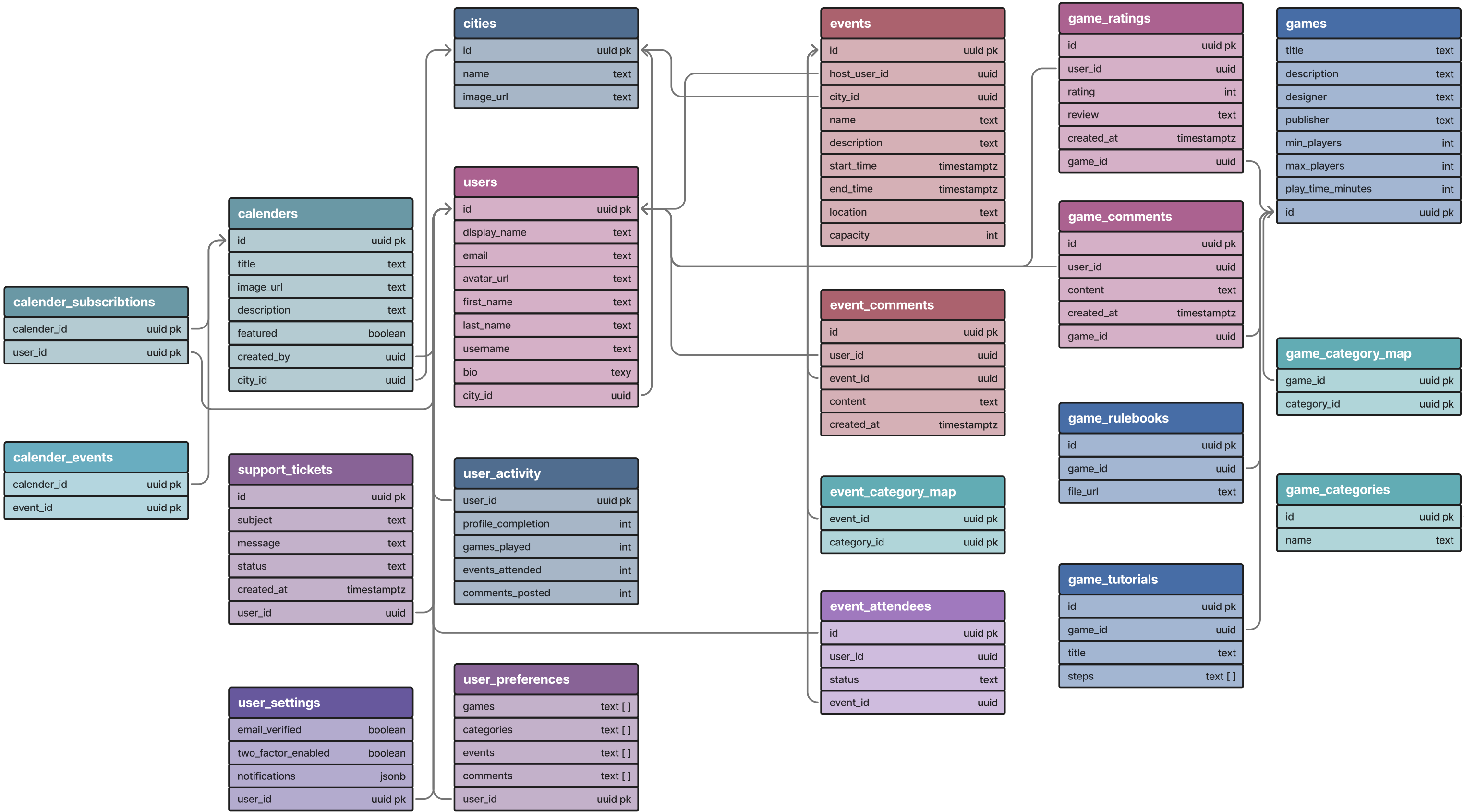
Oluwademilade Aluko,
Lead Developer

Development Process

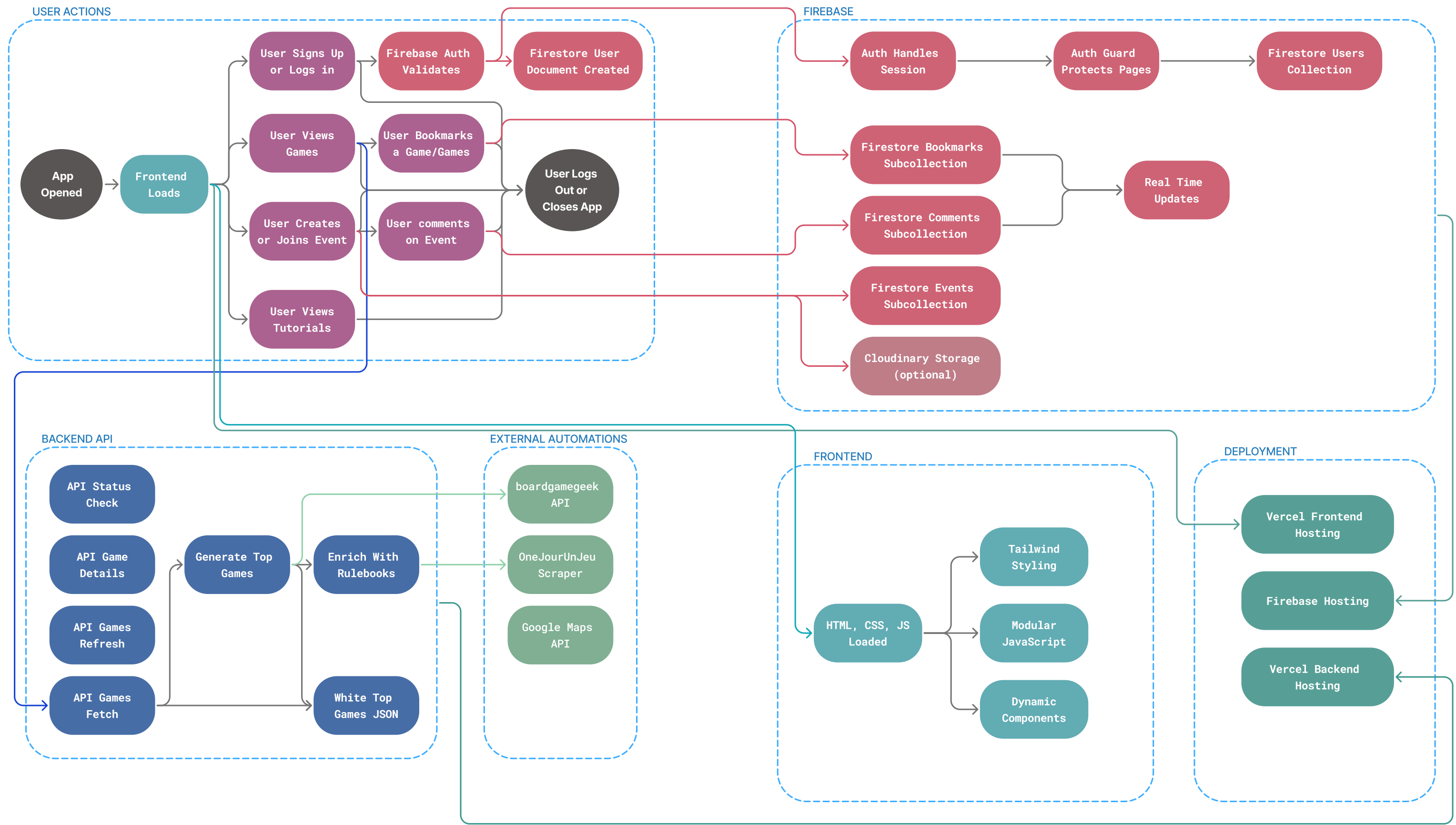
Data Model & Game Structures

System Architecture

Data Model



System Architecture





Mekhala Manappatt,
UX/UI Designer

Business Strategy

Target Market & Growth Strategy

Revenue Mode

Partnership & Expansion Strategy

Phase-Based Rollout

Business Strategy

1. Target Market & Growth Strategy

Primary Audience: Casual players aged 20–34, especially beginners and socially motivated gamers

User Acquisition Channels:

- Social media campaigns on Instagram, TikTok, and Reddit board game communities
- Influencer partnerships with board game YouTubers and Twitch streamers
- Collaborations with local board game cafés and community centers

Retention Strategy:

- Personalized recommendations and achievement badges
- Friend invites and group event planning tools
- Regular updates with new game tutorials and seasonal content

2. Revenue Model

Freemium Model:

- Free access to basic tutorials and public events
- Premium tier unlocks:
 - Advanced tutorials
 - Custom player stats tracking
 - Exclusive event invites and community perks

Event Listings & Sponsorships:

- Local cafés and board game groups pay to feature their events
- Sponsored tutorials or placements for new game launches

In-App Marketplace (Phase 2):

- Commission on secondhand board game sales or swaps
- Affiliate links to online board game retailers

3. Partnership & Expansion Strategy

Cafés & Libraries:

- Offer Luma as an onboarding tool for new players in public spaces
- Event calendar integrations with local venues

Board Game Publishers:

- Partner for official interactive tutorials and featured placements
- Data feedback loop on how users interact with specific game

Educational Institutions:

- Position Luma as a tool for social learning and cognitive training

4. Phase-Based Rollout

Phase

MVP Launch	Focused on 10 popular beginner-friendly games, desktop-first version
User Testing	Partner with local cafés and meetups for feedback
Version 1.0	Public release with full tutorial library, events, and community tools
Expansion	Premium tier, mobile version, marketplace, and partnerships with game publishers



Aboubakar Muco,
Developer

Meet the Team

The Tired Raccoon

Why Us

The Tired Raccoon



Zin Min Htun
*Project Manager
& Developer*



Ana Paola de Morais
Lead UX/UI Designer



Oluwademilade Aluko
Lead Developer



Aboubakar Muco
Developer



Mekhala Manappatt
UX/UI Designer



Sahil Kumar
UX/UI Designer



Nil Yilmaz
UX/UI Designer

We juggle school, work, and passion projects and still deliver. Our strength lies in showing up, even when we're running on caffeine and willpower.

Deadlines shift. Features evolve. Sleep is a luxury. We adjust fast, learn faster, and keep things moving no matter what comes our way, we adapt every situation.

We support each other like a true raccoon pack. Late nights, tight deadlines we handle it all together with humor and trust.



Why Us

Because we've lived the struggle.

We've sat at game nights pretending to understand rules. We've opened rulebooks and quietly closed them again. We've watched potential players give up before the game even started. And we knew it could be better.

Our team is made up of designers, developers, and board game lovers who bring a unique mix of UX expertise, visual storytelling, and community insight. We care deeply about making games accessible—not just playable—for everyone.

We didn't just build Luma as a school project. We built it because we needed it, and so did our friends, families, and fellow confused gamers.

We believe in community. We believe in clarity. We believe in fun that doesn't come with a 45-page explanation.

That's why us.



Sahil Kumar,
UX/UI Designer

References & Special Thanks

References

Illustrations

All custom illustrations featured in the app and the proposal were created by **Nil Yilmaz** and **Ana Paola de Moraes**.

Images

Visual assets and photographs used within the app interface such as event posters, user profiles etc., are taken and owned by **Nil Yilmaz** and **Ana Paola de Moraes**, unless otherwise noted.

Board game thumbnails, game profile images and info are sourced from **BoardGameGeek.com**.

Game Content

The game **The Night Cage** is used as an example throughout the tutorial and interface screens.

All information and gameplay details related to The Night Cage are derived directly from the **official game rulebook**.

Tutorial Videos

Tutorial videos were produced and edited by **Nil Yilmaz** and **Ana Paola de Moraes**, using original components and rulebook content from The Night Cage board game.

Special Thanks

A very special thanks to **Semih Çetin**, who—despite all common sense—never once refused to be our user tester. Not even after the 4th hour. Or the 14th. Your patience, questionable life choices, and heroic ability to click the same button 20 times while pretending it was “totally different this time” will never be forgotten. We owe you one. (But we’re not telling you when it’s due.)

And to **Josué Menjimar**, who haunted our design files like the spirit of a typographic perfectionist—cursing every widow, orphan, and misaligned pixel with the unblinking stare of a designer who sees everything.

Also thanks to **Don Gillard** so very much, for bravely protecting the MakerSpace printer from our totally reasonable and not-at-all last-minute requests. Your commitment to ink, glue and 3D foam conservation is legendary and we respect your ability to ignore all lifeforms in every conceivable timelines.

To our **friends and family**, thank you for not disowning us during this project.

Despite the missed calls, unread messages, and general disappearance from society—we appreciate you for sticking around, not abandoning us, and occasionally reminding us to eat, sleep, or blink.

Your patience, love, and willingness to pretend everything was “totally fine” meant the world. You’re the real heroes of this chaos.





lumaboardgames.com